



North American Vendor Transportation Manual

Last updated – October 2020

Missing, incomplete, inconsistent or confusing information in this document – [let us know!](#)

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Summary of latest changes

Version	Release Month	Section # and Comments
2020 Q2	03/2020	The original NA Vendor Preparation and Transportation Manual has been split in two separate documents. This is the first version of the NA Vendor Transportation Manual. The new NA Vendor Preparation manual can be accessed through NA Vendor Prep Manual.

Introduction

The North American Vendor Transportation Manual provides Amazon's vendors with information, best practice guidelines and requirements regarding the transportation of shipments to Amazon's fulfillment network. The policies and procedures described in this manual are intended to maximize operational efficiencies and maintain the highest safety and quality standards for both Amazon





and our vendors. To ensure that these goals are met, follow the guidelines at all times. Note that failure to comply with the requirements in most cases will cause:

- A delay in receipt of your goods risking an out of stock situation
- A delay in payment due to overages or shortages
- A chargeback

The North American Vendor Transportation Manual contains four Addendums. The Addendums can be accessed below:

- [Addendum 1: Shipping Guidelines \(WePay\)](#)
- [Addendum 2: Amazon Contracted LTL Carrier PRO Distribution Guide](#)
- [Addendum 3: Vendor Intermodal Loading Guide](#)
- [Addendum 4: Special Handling Requirements](#)

Detailed Pallet Preparation and Transportation Instructions

1 Fulfillment of Purchase Orders

Ensure that all terms of the Purchase Order (PO) are met, including:

1.1. General PO requirements:

- 1.1.1. POs are required to be acknowledged, i.e., accept, reject, or backorder (if allowed) within **one day** of the order date. Vendors can edit their PO confirmation information up to two days after their order date or 14 days before their ASN Ship Date, whichever is later.
- 1.1.2. Ship the same items (UPC, EAN, ASIN, ISBN, etc) in the same quantities that were confirmed. Verify that the unit of measure (i.e. individual vs. case) being shipped is consistent with the PO.
- 1.1.3. Amazon does not accept substitutions or replacement products. Shipped products that were never ordered are subject to disposal and may result in liquidation from inventory. This includes products ordered on the PO but where we received a quantity in excess of expected quantity (overage). In case of disposal or liquidation, Amazon will not pay vendors.
- 1.1.4. Vendors can view their 'Past Due' PO Items within Vendor Central by going to Orders > Purchase Orders > Update past due PO items. The expected ship or delivery dates of each past due item must be updated in order to avoid cancellation on the specified cancel date.

1.2. WePay/Collect PO requirements:

- 1.2.1. Accepted PO items are expected to ship to Amazon within the specified ship window that is defined in the PO header. The ship window is defined by Amazon and updating your Expected Ship Date (ESD) does not extend your ship/delivery window.
- 1.2.2. An ESD must be provided every time a backordered PO acknowledgement is submitted. Backordered PO items are expected to ship to Amazon within the ESD provided by the vendor. When some or all of the backordered PO are fulfilled, do not change the original acknowledgement status.
- 1.2.3. If you are a collect vendor (Amazon arranges and pays for freight charges), freight **must** have a routing requested pickup date within the shipping window. Refer to [Section 4: Transporting your Shipments](#) for more information.

1.3. TheyPay/Prepaid PO requirements:

- 1.3.1. Accepted PO items are expected to arrive at Amazon within the specified delivery window that is defined in the PO header. The delivery window is defined by Amazon and updating your Expected Delivery Date (EDD) does not extend your delivery window.
- 1.3.2. An EDD must be provided every time a backordered PO acknowledgement is submitted. Backordered PO items are expected to arrive at Amazon within the EDD provided by the vendor. When some or all of the backordered PO are fulfilled, do not change the original acknowledgement status.
- 1.3.3. If you are a prepaid vendor (vendor arranges and pays for freight charges), your carrier must request an appointment date in Carrier Central that falls within the delivery window. Refer to [Section 4: Transporting your Shipments](#) for more information.

Review chargebacks applicable to purchase orders here:

<https://vendorcentral.amazon.com/hz/vendor/members/support/help/node/G201266820>

2 Pallet Building

2.1 Acceptable Pallet Types



- 2.1.1** Use GMA grade B or higher, 40" x 48" / 1m x 1.25m 4-way access, wood pallets. GMA grade A pallets are required for grocery items.
- 2.1.2** CHEP or PECO pallets meeting GMA grade A and B industry standards are acceptable. However, CHEP or PECO pallet returns or exchanges are not supported by Amazon.
- 2.1.3** Pallet slats must be less than 5" apart to reduce opportunity for compression damage.
- 2.1.4** Do not use pallets that are broken or pallets with missing slats.
- 2.1.5** Do not ship items on pallets made of weak materials, such as cardboard or particle board.
- 2.1.6** Do not ship items in gaylords (pallet-sized cartons).
- 2.1.7** Pallets that break these compliance measures are subject to refusal at the dock due to safety concerns.

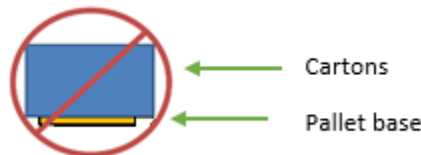
2.2 Pallet Building Guidelines

- 2.2.1** Amazon prefers palletized loads for less-than-truckload and truckload shipments. Amazon prefers floor loaded loads for small parcel and intermodal (rail) shipments. ([Section 5: Loading Shipments](#) presents instructions for floor loaded shipments)
- 2.2.2** Regardless of pallet height, pallets must not exceed 1600.0 lbs/726 kg in gross weight.
- 2.2.3** Cartons must be properly secured to pallets.
- 2.2.4** Securely stretch-wrap cartons to pallets or secure larger items to pallets using non-metallic bands.
- 2.2.5** Ensure that stretch-wrap completely affixes product to the pallet, so as to prevent shifting during transit and creates stable platform for pallet stacking in transit.
- 2.2.6** The use of clear stretch-wrap (vs. black) is preferred.
- 2.2.7** Use corner boards to help protect and maintain the stability of cartons in transit. Inventory must be loaded on the pallet in a stable way so when the stretch wrap is removed inventory will not easily fall over but remain stable on the pallet.
- 2.2.8** Refer to [Addendum 1: Shipping Guidelines \(WePay\)](#) for pallet building best practices.
- 2.2.9** If you are shipping TVs, refer to [Addendum 4: Special Handling Requirements](#) for additional special handling requirements.
- 2.2.10** If a set (i.e. cartons intended to be sold together) weighs 100.0 lbs/45.4 kg or greater, then the set must be placed on a single pallet (one complete sellable unit on each pallet) or be clampable. Additionally, all cartons that are part of a set must be shipped on the same pallet.
- 2.2.11** A single, non-clampable sellable carton or unit (e.g. furniture) weighing 100.0 lbs/45.4 kg or greater must always be individually palletized.

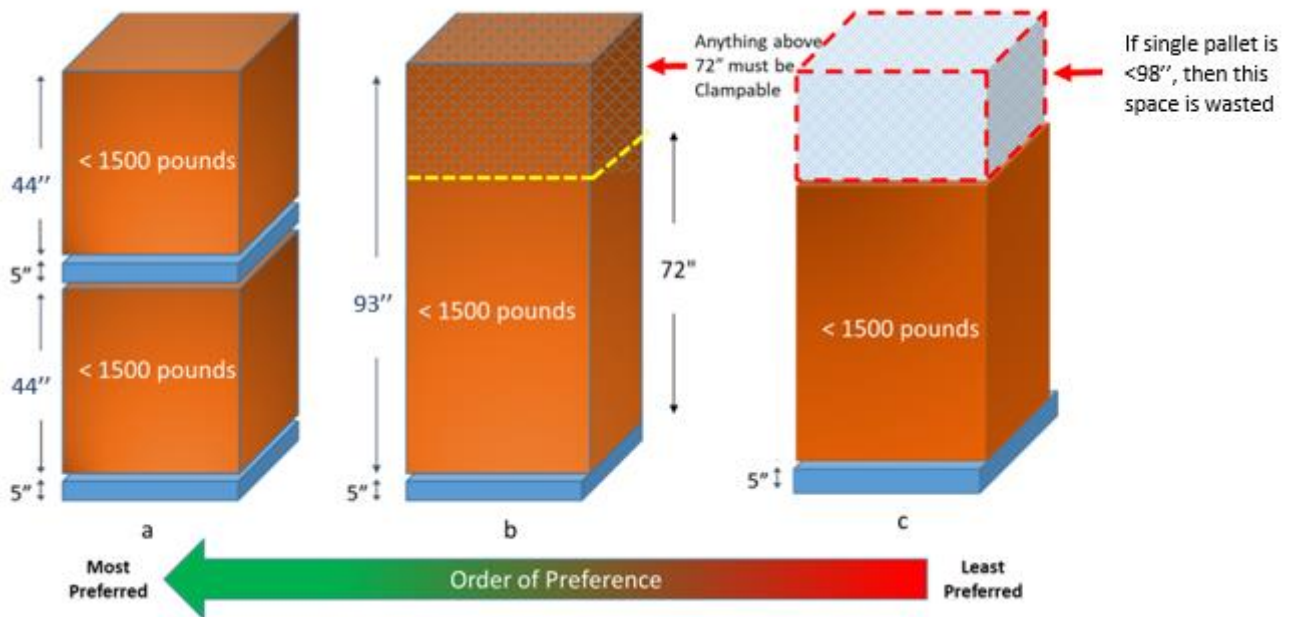
2.3 Stacking

- 2.3.1** When shipping multiple ASINs on a pallet, physically separate the ASINs so that they are easy to differentiate upon receipt.
- 2.3.2** Any guidelines shown on the carton packaging must be followed, such as stack height maximums, carton orientation requirements, and handling restrictions.
- 2.3.3** Build pallets with the carton labels facing outwards to allow each barcode on the carton to be scanned without breaking down the pallet.
- 2.3.4** Stack cartons on pallets so that they are stable and flush on all sides. Brick stacking, with heaviest items on the bottom, is recommended.
- 2.3.5** For single ASIN pallets, all cartons must be stacked the same way (i.e. horizontal or vertical). Cartons can still be turned in different directions, but they all must be stacked in the same way.
- 2.3.6** Do not let cartons overhang the edges of pallets. If a single, large item has any overhang on a standard 40" x 48" / 1m x 1.25m pallet, use a pallet size and type that is suitable for the item with no overhang and 5" maximum under hang on any one side.

2.4 Pallet Height



- 2.4.1** **Most preferred** – Pallets should be built 49" tall (44" of inventory + 5" of pallet height) with solid, flat tops that can be stacked for best truck utilization.
- 2.4.2** If inventory cannot be double stacked or if better utilization can be achieved, build clampable pallets up to 98" tall (93" of inventory + 5" of pallet height) within specifications outlined in section 5.3.



2.4.3 Least Preferred - If inventory cannot be handled with a clamp truck, maximum pallet height is 72".

Review chargebacks applicable to packaging, cartons, and pallets:
<https://vendorcentral.amazon.com/hz/vendor/members/support/help/node/G201266920>

3 Labeling Pallets

3.1 Pallet Labeling

It is mandatory for vendors to provide a pallet label on **every pallet** they ship. Depending on whether you are shipping a multi ASIN pallet or a single ASIN pallet, the pallet labelling requirements will differ. Vendors are still required to attach a carton label to **every carton** on a pallet in addition to pallet label.

3.1.1 General Pallet Labeling Requirements

3.1.1.1 Every pallet must have a pallet label with the following information:

- Pallet # ____ of ____
- Bill of Lading (BOL) number
- SKU # (for single SKU) or "Mixed SKU" on label
- PRO (carrier tracking number)
- PO number(s) contained within pallet. PO number(s) must be barcoded.

3.1.1.2 Pallet labels must be placed squarely (not on an angle) on two sides of the pallet.

3.1.1.3 Pallet labels must be placed on the outside of the plastic wrap.

Review chargebacks applicable to labels:
<https://vendorcentral.amazon.com/st/vendor/members/help?topicId=201266920>

4 Transporting your shipments

4.1 Amazon Paid Freight [Collect / WePay] Requirements

Ship Method	Routing Request Required	Routing Cutoff	Earliest Tender Received (Requested Pickup Date)	BOL Required	ASN Required
Small Parcel (SP)	Yes	23:59 PST/PDT - 2 business days prior to Requested Pickup Date	4am PST/PDT business day prior to Requested Pickup Date	No	Yes
Less-Than Truck Load (LTL)	Yes	23:59 PST/PDT - 2 business days prior to Requested Pickup Date	4am PST/PDT business day prior to Requested Pickup Date	Yes	Yes
Full Truck Load (TL)	Yes	23:59 PST/PDT - 2 business days prior to Requested Pickup Date	4am PST/PDT business day prior to Requested Pickup Date	Yes	Yes

- 4.1.1** Routing requests are REQUIRED for all collect/WePay shipments. Submit your routing request via either Vendor Central or EDI 753 shortly after confirming your purchase order and after you have an accurate estimate of your shipping details. Vendors must ship with the assigned carrier and follow the carrier's loading requirements.
- 4.1.2** When submitting a routing request, Vendors can tell Amazon if they're shipping a PO in full or across multiple shipments. Vendors will also be shown potential consolidation opportunities in order to consolidate shipments as much as possible. The shipment details page also include SKU images to further help vendors identify what items are included on each shipment. Additionally, Amazon will automatically populate pick up details such the warehouse location, pick up date, and packing details like weight and volume. Once completed, confirm the information is accurate before submitting the request for transportation (ensure the requested pick up date must fall within the ship window on the PO to avoid PO on-time accuracy chargebacks). Please follow carrier loading requirements and ship with the assigned carrier.
- 4.1.3** All POs shipping into the same destination must be consolidated into a single routing request. For additional information on routing request consolidation, shipping best practices, drop trailer shipments, and shipping escalations, refer to [Addendum 1: Shipping Guidelines](#).
- 4.1.4 While routing:**
- 4.1.4.1** For Truck Load: Maximum weight allowed to route is 40,000 lbs., max volume is 3,500 Cu. Ft., max number of stackable pallets are 52 and un-stackable are 26.
- 4.1.4.2** Non-palletized shipments must be clearly stated with pallet count as '0' while routing.
- 4.1.5** After the routing request is submitted, Amazon will process and assign a carrier. Carrier scheduled pick up date and time will be shared accordingly on Shipment details page and through email notification. Vendors need to make sure that they are sending the shipment with assigned carrier and preparing shipments for pick up on the scheduled pick up date provided by Amazon.
- 4.1.6 Pick Up Expectations:**
- 4.1.6.1** Truck Load/LTL Carriers: Carriers are expected to pick the shipment as per the scheduled pick up date and time shared on the Shipment details page in Vendor Central.
- 4.1.6.2** For Small Parcel, Amazon only uses UPS Standard Ground and OnTrac. Do not choose air freight. (If you have questions regarding this, inquire using the "Contact Us" feature in Vendor Central or Advantage website). Carrier specific small parcel account numbers are available in Vendor Central ([Vendor Central](#) > Support > Forms and other downloads > Small Parcel Account Numbers & FAQ).
- 4.1.6.3** Vendor must be ready to load and ship the freight on scheduled pick up date available on the shipment details page. All vendors are expected to load carrier's trailers.
- 4.1.6.4** Vendors must submit the carrier a printed BOL at the time of pick up. Refer to *section 7: Documents Required for Shipments – Bill of Lading (BOL)* for more information on BOL requirements.
- 4.1.7** ASNs must be submitted via either Vendor Central or EDI 856 transmission. Additional information related to ASNs, Routing Requests can be found in section 8 of this manual.



4.1.8 For shipments coming into North America, refer to the [Import Related documents](#) in Vendor Central (Vendor Central > Support > Resource Center > Resource Center > Operations). There you will find for international account numbers and additional requirements for Import Shipments.

4.1.9 Expedited Shipping:

4.1.9.1 Shipments are to be expedited at the discretion of your Retail Representative. Reach out to them for eligibility checks and possible next steps.

4.1.9.2 If you have not been instructed to expedite a shipment and you believe your shipment should be expedited, submit a Routing Request with the earliest possible Freight Ready Date.

4.2 Vendor Paid Freight [Prepaid / TheyPay] Requirements

4.2.1 Though we acknowledge the discretion of our vendors to ship prepaid shipments via their own carrier, Amazon strongly recommends that you utilize our contracted carriers. Amazon's contracted carriers are better prepared to handle shipments into our locations, as they are fully aware of the particular freight management requirements that are necessary to best serve our account and accomplish deliveries in the most expeditious and economical manner possible.

4.2.2 All shipments, including Small Parcel shipments, require an ASN (Advanced Shipment Notification). ASNs can be submitted via Vendor Central or Advantage website (in the Shipments tool under the ORDERS tab) or EDI 856 (see [EDI Specifications Document](#) in Vendor Central: Support > View Resource Center > View Resource Center > EDI Specification for 856 Advanced Shipment Notification 5010 Version).

4.2.3 Carrier Expectations

4.2.3.1 Carriers that are selected by the vendor to deliver "Vendor Paid" shipments to Amazon FCs must comply with this manual. It is the responsibility of the vendor to ensure that the requirements outlined in this manual are followed by the carrier. Vendors should note that the failure of a carrier to comply with these requirements may cause the delivery to be refused.

4.2.3.2 Vehicle Condition: The following standards of vehicle condition are required when delivering goods to Amazon FCs:

4.2.3.2.1 The vehicle floor must be able to withstand the weight and height of a 13 foot, 6 inch powered industrial truck (or forklift) to offload freight.

4.2.3.2.2 The vehicle floor must be well maintained, safe, and free from any obstructions and damage, such as holes.

4.2.3.2.3 The use of trailers with uneven or corrugated floors, (such as in refrigerated trailers) is highly discouraged. In the event that product must be shipped in a climate controlled trailer, product must be palletized.

4.2.3.2.4 The vehicle must be water tight, clean and free of strong odors, especially when delivering food and healthcare products.

4.2.3.2.5 Securing straps must not be allowed to hang freely. Straps, unless actually securing a load(s), must be firmly fixed to the vehicle so that they present no danger to staff and ensure accessibility to the goods being unloaded. Load bars, tension straps, air pillows, and/or diamond corrugate shims must be used to secure any double stacked pallet that may shift in transit or has a large void of space to the pallet's front, rear, or sides. Load bars or tension straps must also be used to secure the final pallets placed on a trailer in order to prevent freight from falling when doors are opened.

4.2.4 Timeliness of Deliveries

4.2.4.1 Amazon schedules appointments and labor resources to ensure a vehicle's waiting time is kept to a minimum. In order to achieve this, suppliers must ensure that the agreed appointment time is met. Suppliers are also reminded to carefully check the warehouse address before the delivery is made.

4.2.4.2 If a carrier/supplier recognizes that a delivery may be late, they must contact the respective FC Transportation Scheduler (866-203-8372). Amazon will make every effort to accommodate late arrivals provided this does not adversely affect other suppliers' delivery times.

4.2.4.3 An appointment will be given a 30 minute grace period past the scheduled delivery time before it is considered late. Late deliveries are subject to cancellation of the appointment. If an appointment is cancelled, the carrier must request a new appointment.

4.2.5 Carrier is required to provide the following information upon making delivery. Failure to provide this information will lead to freight refusal or delay in receiving:

4.2.5.1 Amazon Delivery Appointment Number (ISA #)

4.2.5.2 Bill of Lading documentation (see [Appendix 1: Documents Required for Shipments – Bill of Lading \(BOL\)](#) for BOL requirements)

4.2.5.3 Carriers that sub contract to another carrier must also provide that sub contracted carrier with the above 2 along with PRO # or carrier tracking number given to vendors.



- 4.2.6** Amazon reserves the right to suspend or deny scheduling of delivery appointments to any carrier or driver, with sufficient notice, on grounds of repeated or excessive late delivery or disruptive behavior or violation of any yard policy (including, but not limited to speeding and / or littering).

4.3 Carrier Central

- 4.3.1** All carriers are required to utilize Carrier Central (<https://carriercentral.amazon.com/>) to request a delivery appointment at Amazon's FCs. Note that this requirement applies to less-than-truckload (LTL) and truckload (TL) shipments and does not apply to small parcel shipments. For more information on small parcel, refer to the document in Vendor Central -> <https://vendorcentral.amazon.com/gp/vendor/members/downloads/download> -> Operations -> Small Parcel Account Numbers & FAQs - Amazon Paid Shipments.
- 4.3.2 What should vendors do?**
- 4.3.2.1** Vendors must inform their carriers of this portal. Carriers need to visit the Carrier Central Portal at <https://carriercentral.amazon.com/> and request an account. Vendors must provide complete order information to the carrier to ensure accurate and complete information upload into Carrier Central.
- 4.3.2.2** Vendors must ensure carriers have a valid SCAC before the carrier submits a Carrier Central account request.
- 4.3.2.3** Vendors must not request a Carrier Central account on behalf of their carrier as that request will be denied.
- 4.3.2.4** Vendors must ensure carriers provide accurate pallet count, carton count and unit count information in Carrier Central.
- 4.3.3** Carriers must utilize the 'HELP' link located on the login page of Carrier Central for assistance.
- 4.3.4** Additional appointment information for Vendor Paid Freight:
- 4.3.4.1** All carriers delivering vendor paid freight are required to schedule delivery appointment 24 hours or more in advance of the desired appointment date. The carrier must specify a desired appointment date and time on the request form.
- 4.3.4.2** Prepaid Vendors are responsible for ensuring their carriers deliver within the delivery window.
- 4.3.4.3** Vendors must provide the carrier with a complete list of Purchase Order #s, PRO # and BOL information, and instruct the carrier that Amazon will require this information when scheduling a dock appointment.
- 4.3.4.4** Upon arriving at the FC, the carrier must provide a physical BOL document that meets Amazon's requirements. See [Appendix 1: Documents Required for Shipments – Bill of Lading \(BOL\)](#) for BOL requirements.
- 4.3.5** If your carrier is having appointment related issues, ask your carrier to contact the respective FC Scheduler and/or submit a case through Amazon NOC Case Management. For respective FC Scheduler details or any technical assistance, carrier can refer to the Carrier Central help section. If your carrier doesn't find a solution to their issue, create a 'Contact Us' case via Vendor Central.

Review chargebacks applicable to transportation:

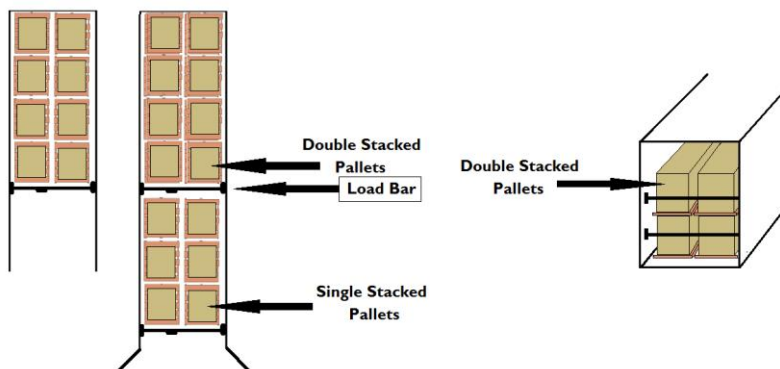
<https://vendorcentral.amazon.com/hz/vendor/members/support/help/node/G201266760>

5 Loading Shipments

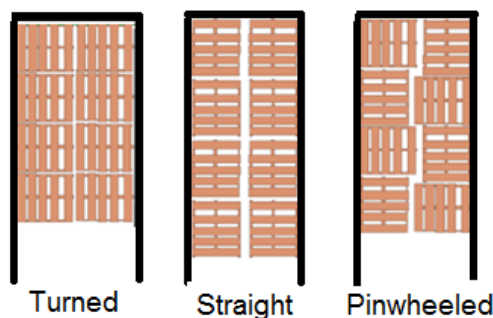
Amazon is providing the following loading shipment guidelines as a summary description of general best practices for ensuring that shipments are loaded in a manner that will prevent shifting and also improve loading, transportation and unloading. The requirements of an exceptional situation may require alternative measures. Under all circumstances, loading must be completed in consultation with the carrier, and any conflicting carrier instruction will supersede these guidelines. Note additional guidelines for loading of intermodal containers in [Addendum 3: Vendor Intermodal Loading Guide](#).

5.1 Pallet Loading

- 5.1.1** Arrange double stacked pallets so that both pallets are accessible by a forklift from the same side. Load bars, tension straps, air pillows, and/or diamond corrugate shims must be used to secure any double stacked pallet that may shift in transit or has a large void of space to the pallet's front, rear, or sides. Load bars or tension straps must also be used to secure the final pallets placed on a trailer in order to prevent freight from falling when doors are opened. Tension straps must not be hanging free and must be secured if not used.



- 5.1.2** Pallet loading for truckload (TL) shipments should use a “Turned” configuration. This is 2 rows of pallets with the 48” dimension running on the width of the trailer and the 40” dimension running along the length dimension (see example below). This provides the best overall mix of utilization and load stability and provides space for 26 (single stacked) or 52 (double stacked) pallets. Straight or pinwheel pallet arrangements, while allowed, may not allow you to fit all your freight on the trailer.
- 5.1.3** All trailers must have adequate strength cardboard placed against the cargo and secured in place using load bars/straps to prevent carton contact with the rear doors. 6" at the back of the trailer must be maintained to allow space for the dock plate to be engaged. It is the shipper and the carrier’s responsibility to ensure that shipments are loaded into a trailer in a balanced manner that prevents the load from shifting during transit or unloading. Products must be shrink wrapped together to prevent insecure loading. For intermodal loads, see the [Addendum 3: Vendor Intermodal Loading Guide](#).



5.2 Floor-Loading

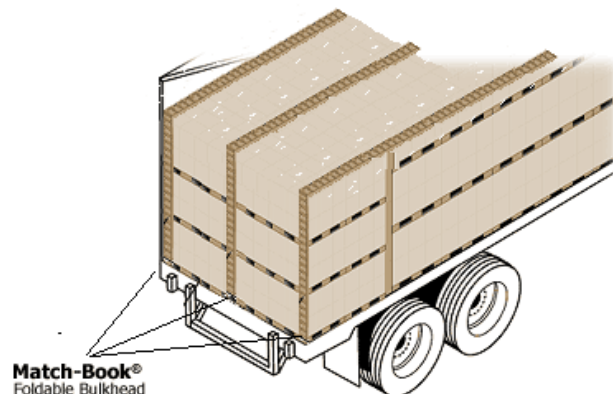
- 5.2.1** Palletize all shipments as much as possible to ensure earlier delivery appointments. Trailers loaded without the use of pallets are referred to as being ‘floor loaded’. Floor loaded shipments are required by Small Parcel carriers (SP), and allowed for truckload (TL) and intermodal/rail shipments (IM). Floor loaded shipments are not allowed for Less-than-Truckload carriers (LTL).
- 5.2.2** Floor loaded shipments requiring extensive handling may be refused for safety reasons (i.e. boxes greater than 50.0 pounds). By definition, Amazon considers floor loading to be loose, stacked cartons, which are under 50.0 pounds in weight that will be unloaded by hand. Any additional charges assessed would vary based on the extra labor required which can vary significantly from shipment to shipment. Parcel shipments are allowed to be greater than 50 lbs. if there is one unit per box. Apply a load strap or a load bar at the end of the trailer to provide an additional layer of load security.
- 5.2.3** Stack cartons into columns in an alternating pattern to provide stability (T-Stacked). Cartons must not be bundled together with any kind of straps, zip ties, tape, etc.
- 5.2.4** Only floor-load freight into containers that are at least 96”/ 2.5m tall.
- 5.2.5** When loading the trailer, maintain stability between cartons stacks and container walls. Cartons must never be forced into a trailer into spaces that are smaller than the box size to prevent difficulty during the unload process.
- 5.2.6** All shipments must be properly secured using load bars/straps. It is the shipper’s and the carrier’s responsibility to ensure that shipments are loaded into a trailer in a manner that prevents the load from shifting during transit.



Example of floor loaded product correctly staged in a container

5.3 Clamp Truck Guidelines

- 5.3.1** Any Floor Loaded trailer must be clearly labeled as being 'clampable' or 'non-clampable'. If freight is described as clampable, it must be able to be completely unloaded from a trailer using a Clamp attachment to a powered industrial equipment for lift. If freight is described as non-clampable, it can only be unloaded from a trailer by hand. Products that are greater than 50 lbs. per unit must be clampable. Clampable freight must be less than 78" to allow the clamp to grip the freight.
- 5.3.2** When loading the trailer, maintain at least 6" / 16 cm between freight and container ceiling, as well as 6" at the back of the trailer to allow space for the dock plate to be engaged. In addition, trailers must maintain 6" between freight and either side of the trailer AND THE CENTER LINE to allow a safe distance for the clamp truck driver to maneuver between pallets. Corrugate shims must be used in the 6-inch gaps between the walls and center lines to prevent sideways movement of the load.



- 5.3.3** Boxes/cases must be wrapped tight in stacks that are no more than 40" wide, 48" long, and 72" tall to be able to accommodate min and max clamp truck restrictions. Clampable cartons must not be forced into a trailer during the load process. If the individual unit is one unit per box and is greater than 50 lbs, the stack can be 40" wide, 72" long and 72" tall. If the individual unit is one unit per box and is too large to fit on the 40" by 48" or the 40" by 72" pallet, please see the Special Handling Addendum on Custom Pallets.
- 5.3.4** The product must also be oriented in such a manner that it can be clamped without having to rearrange the load. For example, if mattresses are oriented in such a fashion that the larger flat surface is facing the rear end of the truck, a clamp truck can't move them without rearranging such that the larger flat surface faces the side walls of the trailer.
- 5.3.5** Arrange each tier to be uniform and aligned relative to the other tiers on the footprint so that all four sides of the freight stack can be safely 'squeezed' by a clamp. Tier heights may vary.



6 Safety and Quality Requirements

6.1 Trailer/Shipment Safety and Loading Requirements

- 6.1.1** Due to safety concerns, the use of trailers with uneven or corrugated floors such as those in refrigerated trailers are discouraged but are acceptable for use. In the event that product must be shipped in a climate controlled trailer, product is preferred to be palletized. Non-palletized (floor loaded) product that arrives to Amazon FCs on a trailer with uneven or corrugated floors will be refused.



- 6.1.2** A trailer, shipment or portion of a shipment is subject to refusal at the FC if FC associates are unable to safely unload product from the trailer or to verify the contents of a shipment. Common reasons for freight refusals include, but are not limited to:
 - 6.1.2.1** Pallets shifting in transit.
 - 6.1.2.2** Pallets/product stacked in a manner that prevents the FC from safely unloading the product.
 - 6.1.2.3** Over-sized floor loaded product that exceeds 100 lbs (mech lift) and cannot be unloaded by a clamp.
- 6.1.3** If there are multiple pallets for the same PO, all pallets of the same PO must be loaded together throughout the trailer, provided all overweight axle guidelines are met.
- 6.1.4** Under all circumstances, shipments must be loaded in a manner that is balanced and that prevents the load from shifting.

6.2 Quality Assurance

In an effort to help our vendors meet operational expectations, Amazon collects and reviews vendor operational performance data on a continual basis. We use this data to identify and address noncompliance in vendor operations. Depending on the severity of noncompliance, Amazon may initiate communication with vendors in a number of ways to help bring awareness and a resolution to the situation. Vendors may receive a one-time contact regarding an isolated incident or may have ongoing communication with an Amazon representative in order to rectify consistent problems. Amazon will often share data in order to educate vendors on operational issues. Whenever necessary, Amazon may return merchandise at vendors' expense and/or assess charges to vendors to offset expenses incurred as a result of vendor non-compliance with operational standards. To help ensure continuous levels of quality, it is necessary to communicate to your Retail Representative well in advance of any circumstances that may compromise or interrupt service, such as system changes or facility closures.

7 ARN Destination Change

In unusual circumstances when Amazon Fulfillment Centers are experiencing larger backlogs than normal, Amazon could initiate a destination change request of an ARN. This will only occur after the routing request creation and after prior to the ARN being assigned a carrier.

7.1 ARN Destination Change Communication and Requirements:

- 7.1.1** When an ARN destination change is requested by Amazon, the email below will be sent as an initial confirmation. The BOL must be updated to reflect the new destination as well as the ASN. Please note that pallet and carton labels **do not** need to be updated to the new destination fulfillment center.
- 7.1.2** Email: upstream-arn-redirects@amazon.com
 Subject: ARN Destination Change
 Hello,
 We have changed the destination on the following shipment to reduce pickup delay and receive the units sooner. The following ARN(s) and PO(s) were changed:
 - ARN(s):
 - PO(s):
 - New Destination FC:
 Please update destination on the BOL and ASN. You do **NOT** need to update your pallet or carton labels. Thank you for your cooperation and flexibility.

8 Documents Required for Shipments – Bill of Lading (BOL)

- 8.1** BOLs are required for all TL/LTL shipments. Vendors are responsible for BOL accuracy, including handling unit quantity information. **Information must be printed, NOT handwritten.** BOLs missing the required information will need to be corrected and reprinted at time of pickup. A sample Bill of Lading is listed in *Appendix 4: Sample Bill of Lading*. The following information is required on all BOLs:

Amazon Requirement:

Parameter	Requirement	Description & Comments
Amazon Reference Numbers (ARN)	Mandatory for all Collect/ WePay shipments	If your shipment has multiple ARNs, you must list all of them.



General Requirements:

Parameter	Requirements	Descriptions & Comments
BOL Number	Mandatory for all shipments	A unique number assigned by the shipper when creating the Bill of Lading.
Ship From Information	Mandatory for all shipments	You must include the following information: • Vendor Name • Street Address • City, State and Zip Code • DC Contact Name and Phone
Ship To Information	Mandatory for all shipments	You must include the following information: • Amazon FC Name • Street Address, • City, State and Zip Code
Routed Carrier Name and SCAC	Mandatory for all shipments	Carrier name and SCAC (Standard Carrier Alpha Code) are required as provided in the tender notification.
Carrier's reference number (PRO #)	Mandatory for all shipments	The PRO number is a unique identifier issued by a Carrier to track a shipment from pickup to delivery. This PRO number must be used by the Carrier delivering the shipment to Amazon (This number CANNOT be changed in-transit).
Freight Charge Terms	Mandatory for all shipments	Check the appropriate freight terms box on your BOL: COLLECT, PREPAID, 3rd PARTY (check box on BOL form)
Amazon Reference Numbers (ARN)	Mandatory for all Collect/ WePay shipments	If your shipment has multiple ARNs, you must list all of them.
Customer Order Number (Purchase Order)	Mandatory for all shipments	List all Amazon Purchase Orders and invoice numbers (if you have invoice number at the time of shipment).
Handling unit quantity information	Mandatory for all shipments	Vendors must list pallet, carton, and each information. For ARN/PO, all 3 units of measure are required.
Trailer and Seal	Mandatory for all shipments	Trailer and seal number can be handwritten. All seals must be ISO 17712 compliant and meet the following criteria: Strong and durable against weather, chemical action, and undetectable tampering. Must be easy to apply and seal. Permanently and uniquely marked / numbered, and marked with an easily identifiable manufacturer's logo. All truckload shipments, high-value shipments (>\$250,000 USD) and shipments traveling more than 250 miles from origin to destination must receive a high-security bolt seal, with seal number notated on BOL.
Shipper Load and Count (SLC)	Mandatory for all shipments	"Shipper Load and Count" or "SLC" must be printed on BOL when trailer is loaded and sealed without driver being given the opportunity to count or inspect freight.

- 8.2 Consolidate ARNs with the same origin and destination on a single BOL per the tender notification. Refer to [Addendum 1: Shipping Guidelines \(WePay\)](#) for consolidated routing guidelines.
- 8.3 All ARNs contained in the same shipment must be listed on the BOL and confirmed with the carrier at pickup. If shipping orders for a party that fulfills through Amazon FCs, create a separate BOL. Do not combine Amazon shipments with shipments for other sellers that fulfill through Amazon FCs.
- 8.4 Original BOL information must be made available to the carrier in order for carrier to arrange a delivery appointment at the FC.
- 8.5 BOLs can also be printed within Vendor Central > Orders > Shipments > Shipments Landing page for shipments which were submitted via Vendor Central only.



9 Information Required for Shipment - Advanced Shipment Notification (ASN)

- 9.1 ASN is a virtual notification message to communicate information about a shipment prior to delivery. Amazon matches ASNs from Vendors to Shipment Delivery Notifications (SDNs) from Carriers based on ARN / PRO / BOL to support the shipment during the receiving process. (i.e. ASN Match). Vendors are required to submit ASNs for all shipments, regardless of size or freight payment terms. Note: Shipment details page now shows alert if an ASN has not been submitted for a shipment that is past the scheduled pick up date.
- 9.2 Amazon must receive vendor's ASN 24 hours after the departure of the trailer and prior to the vendor's product being received on Amazon's dock. If the Amazon destination FC is in close proximity to vendor's shipping location, we recommend sending ASNs before the departure of the trailer from the shipping location.
- 9.3 Vendors can request a block (set) of PRO numbers from each of Amazon's Contracted LTL Carriers. Refer to Addendum 2 - Amazon Contracted LTL Carrier PRO Distribution Guide for more information.

Review chargebacks applicable to ASNs:

<https://vendorcentral.amazon.com/st/vendor/members/help?topicId=201266640>

10 Routing Requests

- 10.1A routing request only applies to collect (WePay) vendors. When submitting a routing request, Vendors can tell Amazon if they're shipping a PO in full or across multiple shipments so that they are only shown those items that have not yet been added to a shipment. The shipment details page also includes SKU images to further help vendors identify what items are included on each shipment. Additionally, Amazon will automatically populate pick up details such as the warehouse location, pick-up date, and packing details (weight and volume). Confirm the information is accurate before submitting the request for transportation (ensure the requested pick-up date falls within the ship window on the PO to avoid a PO on-time accuracy chargeback). Please follow carrier loading requirements and ship with the assigned carrier.
- 10.2 Routing requests can be submitted via Vendor Central or EDI 753. For all collect (WePay) POs this is the process we use to tender shipments to carriers. Once your request has been submitted, Amazon then sends out this data in an automated format to the designated carrier, as well as the assigned Amazon FC.
- 10.3 Once you have been given a sign-on into your company's Vendor Central account, you can begin utilizing this system immediately for any collect (WePay) Purchase Orders (POs). If you do not see 'Shipments' under ORDERS as an option – reach out to your company's Vendor Central Administrator for assistance. These individuals have the ability to provide you with this access. You can access routing instructions and additional routing information in Vendor Central under the Support > Shipping.
- 10.4 Please see [Section 4 Transporting Your Shipments](#) for routing cutoff times depending on your ship method. You can select a Freight Ready Date (FRD) up to 30 days in the future keeping in mind that the FRD must not exceed the latest ship date of the PO ship window. Consolidate and add as many POs that are going to the same location as possible to one Routing Request. Once the routing request is submitted carrier and pick up details will be shared via email and on the shipments page.
- 10.5 If you are unable to provide the BOL # at the time of routing, you can use an alternate reference number such as an internal order or invoice number (if you have invoice number at the time of shipping). The reference number must be a unique number that your firm must use to reference this shipment. You must later enter the actual BOL # in your ASN and *provide the same to the carrier*.
- 10.6 Submit this information to us via "Contact-Us" (link located at the top of every Vendor Central page) and select 'Shipments' as the Support topic and 'Routing Requests – ...' as the Specific issue. If you are not receiving email confirmations for submitted Routing Requests, it is likely that email confirmations are being sent to an outdated contact in your company/your email address is incorrect in Vendor Central. You can update the contacts and email addresses for your company in the Warehouse Address link of Vendor Central or Advantage website. If after updating your contact information you are still not receiving email confirmations, submit this information to us via "Contact Us." For concerns regarding routing requests reach out to us via "Contact-Us" (link located at the top of every Vendor Central page) and select 'Shipments' as the Support topic and 'Routing Requests – ...' as the Specific issue.
- 10.7 Unless instructed otherwise by Amazon Transportation, vendor must be ready to load and ship the freight on scheduled pick up date available on Shipment details page.
- 10.8 For delivery or pickups issues use the "Contact Us" in Vendor Central to report this information. Select "Routing Requests" or "Shipment Management" as the issue and "Freight Not Picked Up" as the sub-issue.
- 10.9 Routing Requests cannot be edited except for the "requested pick up date". Vendors can submit a new requested pick up date any time up to 5:00 PM (local time zone) the day before the scheduled pick up date. For example, if a vendor's pick up



appointment is scheduled for 10:00 AM on June 2, they can make edits until 5:00 PM on June 1. You cannot add new POs to an already submitted/processed Routing Request. If you have additional POs to ship, submit a separate Routing Request. If you have any questions regarding editing your routing request, submit a "Contact Us" case within Vendor Central. Select "Shipments" as the Support topic and "Routing Requests - Edit Routing Request details" as the specific issue.

11 International Shipments

11.1 For direct imports via small parcel and LTL/TL between US, CA and MX, commercial invoices must be provided for all shipments. Commercial invoices can be generated via Vendor Central during both the ASN and Routing Request submission process. (Vendor Central->Support->Shipping->>About Commercial Invoices has more information.) If you are unable to create a commercial invoice in Vendor Central, ensure that a commercial invoice is completed according to the requirements found in the Trade Compliance manual: (Vendor Central > <https://vendorcentral.amazon.com/gp/vendor/members/downloads/download> ->Operations-> Import Vendor - US Trade Compliance Requirements Manual).

12 FAQ's

12.1 Amazon Freight LTL (AMZX)

12.1.1 What is Amazon Freight LTL (SCAC = AMZX)?

Amazon Freight LTL is Amazon's Less-than-truckload (LTL) transportation provider for Amazon Collect Shipments.

12.1.2 How do I Schedule a pick up for Amazon Freight LTL?

Carrier will show up on the scheduled pick up date available on Shipment details page. We expect the vendor shipment to be ready on the scheduled pick up date and load the shipment accordingly.

12.1.3 How do I procure a PRO label?

Instead of needing to procure PRO labels in advance, with Amazon Freight you print your own PRO labels.

12.1.4 How do I print my own PRO labels?

Click the Amazon Freight PRO Label link (<https://freight.amazon.com/labels>) in the Routing Request Response email.

Log in using any Amazon.com login. Your personal Amazon.com account will work. If you don't have a login then you can create a new one on Amazon.com.

Enter the ARN and Purchase Order provided in the Routing Request Response email and click "Find Shipment" to generate and print the Amazon Freight PRO label.

amazon

Print pallet labels

Print pallet labels for your Less-Than-Truckload (LTL) shipments to Amazon where Amazon Shipping is the carrier.

Amazon Reference Number (ARN) Purchase Order Number (PO #)

Find shipment

The website will bring up your shipment. Adjust the Label paper size if needed and **click "Print Labels"**

amazon

Home > ARN 012345678910

Print pallet labels

Shipment details

PRO # 012345678910	Amazon Reference Number (ARN) 012345678910
Planned pickup date 08/10/2019	Purchase Order (PO): SZCR9P4T, JJ410JJKF

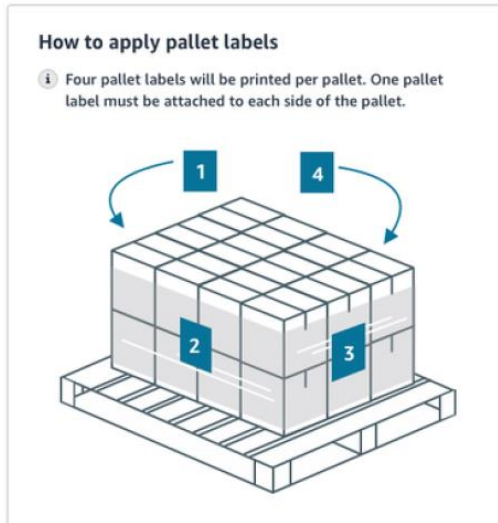
[Show more](#)

Pallet label options
Four pallet labels will be printed per pallet.

Number of pallets 2	Paper size 4 x 6 inches (Recommended)
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12.1.5 Where in the pallet do I apply the PRO labels for my Amazon Freight LTL shipment?

Each pallet gets 4 identical labels. Affix the identical PRO label to all 4 sides of each pallet. The label insures that your goods can be quickly sent to their final destination.



12.1.6 When do I submit the ASN for my Amazon Freight LTL shipment?

Submit your ASN right away – submitting your ASN on the same day as pickup allows Amazon to quickly get your stuff routed to its final destination.

12.1.7 What additional information do I need to know about Amazon Freight LTL?

12.1.7.1 Have your shipment ready on the scheduled pick up date/time available on shipment details page or in the Amazon carrier assignment email notification.

12.1.7.2 Be sure to only load the pallets, cartons and POs that were routed as part of this shipment. Your shipment is part of a consolidated truckload that will also contain shipments from other shippers

12.1.7.3 To cancel or reschedule, request a lift gate or a vehicle smaller than a 53-foot truck, or if the 8-5 pickup window does not work for you, or if you have any other problems, call Amazon Transportation's Relay Operations Center at 866-203-8372 at least 24 hours before the start of your pickup window.

13 Glossary of Terms

ARN (Amazon Reference Number): The ARN is a reference number that Amazon generates when a shipment has been routed and a Carrier has been assigned to make a pick-up. This number is ONLY generated for Collect (WePay) shipments.



ASN (Advanced Shipment Notification): An electronic notification of pending deliveries; a virtual packing list that needs to be sent before the arrival of physical shipment at fulfillment centers for proper labor resource planning.

BOL (Bill of Lading): A document issued by an entity providing transportation services that serves three purposes: 1) serves as receipt for the goods delivered to the carrier for shipment, 2) defines the contract of carriage of the goods from the point of origin to the point of destination according to the responsibilities of the service provider listed on the bill of lading, 3) under certain conditions, provides evidence of title for the goods.

BOL (Bill of Lading) Number: A unique number assigned by the shipper when creating the Bill of Lading.

Carrier Central: Web based portal that carriers utilize to request a delivery appointment at Amazon's FCs.

CHEP Pallet: Commonwealth Handling Equipment Pool Pallet provided by CHEP Pallet Pooling service.

Collect: The consignee (Amazon) pays the freight charges.

Consolidation: Occurs when multiple shipments are combined into one truck.

Cube: The amount of space / volume a shipment occupies on a trailer.

EDI (Electronic Data Interchange): A method of transmitting data in formatted messages electronically between Amazon, vendors, carriers, and drop shippers using the EDI standards X12 (for US and JP) or EDIFACT (for EU).

FBA (Fulfilled By Amazon): A service purchased by third party sellers worldwide to have Amazon store and then pack, ship, and provide customer service for their products.

FC (Fulfillment Center): Amazon facilities, designed to hold goods for extended periods of time and ship product directly to our customers.

GMA Pallet: Pallet specifications provided by Grocery Manufacturers Association (GMA) Pallet Recycling Corporation.

Hazmat (Hazardous Materials): Products which are classified as dangerous goods under the European Agreement concerning the International Carriage of Dangerous Goods by Road (ADR) because they contain flammable, pressurized, corrosive, environmentally hazardous or otherwise harmful substances.

ISTA (International Safe Transit Association): Leading industry developer of testing protocols and design standards that define how packages should perform in the global distribution environment. LINK: <https://www.ista.org/>

IXD (Inbound Crossdock): An Amazon warehouse that accepts freight from vendors/sellers and ships product to various fulfillment centers. IXDs do not ship customer orders.

LTL (Less than Truckload): Typically a shipment that fills <50% of a 53 foot trailer. Freight is consolidated by the carrier before moving to its destination.

ORM-D: Marking for consumer commodities in the United States that identifies other regulated materials for domestic transport only. Packages bearing this mark contain hazardous material in a limited quantity that presents a limited hazard during transportation, due to its form, quantity, and packaging.

Packing List: A vendor prepared document that lists all items and quantities of those items in a particular shipment.

Pallet: Movable platform used to stack cases or boxes to facilitate handling.

PECO Pallet: Pallet from the PECO pallet rental service.

Prepaid: The consignor (Vendor) pays the freight charges.



PRO Number: A unique number assigned by a motor freight carrier to identify a specific shipment.

PO (Purchase Order): The actual contract that Amazon has with the vendors representing our product orders from those vendors.

Retail Representative: Person from Amazon side who purchases goods/manages inventory and/or manages the Amazon/Vendor relationship.

Routing Request: A vendor-facing, web based application (routing can be done in Vendor Central and EDI 753 / 754 for EDI live) that facilitates the movement of inventory from a vendor's distribution center to an Amazon FC. Required for all collect shipments regardless of weight.

SCAC (Standard Carrier Alpha Code): A unique, four-letter alpha code used to identify a carrier.

SSCC (Serial Shipping Container Code): An 18-digit number with 2 zero prefix used to identify logistics units; used in LP Receive.

UPC (Universal Product Code): A standard type of barcode widely used in North America for tracking trade items.

Vendor: The company from whom Amazon purchases goods.

